



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

nūnaṃ ca buddhis* tava na*ati+sūkṣmā |
dharma+artha+kāmeṣv* a+vicakṣaṇā vā |
hetor* a+dṛṣṭasya phalasya yas* tvaṃ* |
praty+akṣam arthaṃ* paribhūya yāsi | |9.54|*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 9, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Certainly, this verse from the Buddhacarita speaks to the limitations of a mind overly focused on the tangible, the immediate, and the material. It suggests that the person being addressed lacks a truly refined understanding, being unskilled in the realms of dharma (righteous conduct), artha (prosperity), and kama (pleasure). The core of the critique lies in the individual's tendency to disregard the obvious, the "pratyaksham artham," in favor of pursuing results from unseen or unproven causes, "hetor adrshtasya phalasya." Essentially, the verse points out the folly of neglecting what is right in front of you while chasing elusive, potentially illusory gains.

In our modern lives, this verse serves as a potent reminder to cultivate mindfulness and discernment. How often do you find yourself overlooking the simple joys, the readily available opportunities for growth and connection, in the pursuit of something grander, something supposedly more fulfilling that remains perpetually out of reach? We are bombarded with messages promising happiness through external achievements, material possessions, or fleeting pleasures, often blinding us to the inherent beauty and value of the present moment. The wisdom of the Buddhacarita urges you to examine your priorities. Are you truly tending to your dharma, living a life of integrity and compassion? Are you cultivating a healthy relationship with artha, using your resources wisely and ethically? And are you experiencing kama in a way that is balanced and nourishing, without becoming enslaved by your desires?

The verse challenges you to recognize that genuine well-being often arises not from chasing distant dreams, but from cultivating wisdom, compassion, and awareness in your daily life. The "pratyaksham artham," the obvious meaning, is often found in the present moment, in the relationships you nurture, in the service you offer, and in the inner peace you cultivate. By focusing on these tangible aspects of your existence, you can create a foundation for lasting happiness and fulfillment, rather than being perpetually driven by the pursuit of something unseen and uncertain.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can I better appreciate and cultivate the "obvious meaning" in my life today, instead of chasing elusive future goals?